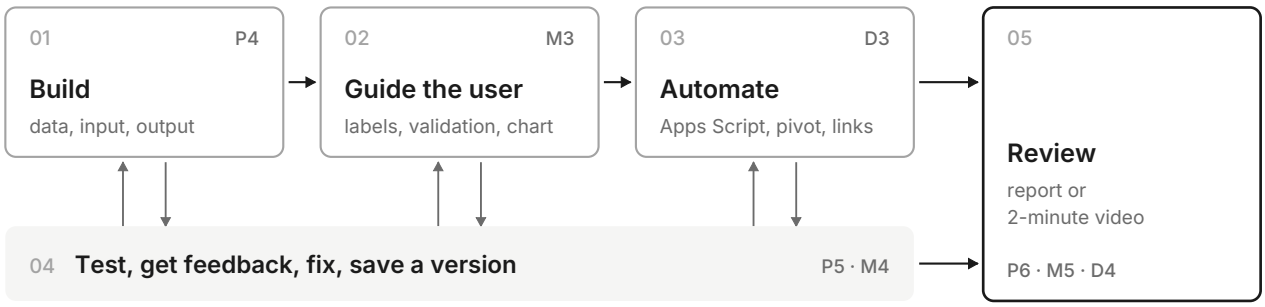
Build, Test and Review Your Spreadsheet

This guide explains what each task asks for and where to find the tools. The design decisions are yours.

Deadline	You hand in	Dataset
Monday 2 November 2026	Your Google Sheet, your test log, and your feedback log with your review (typed report or 2-minute video)	The given dataset, at least **50 rows**

How the five tasks fit together



Tasks 1 to 3 are not done once each. After every change, test it, log it and save a version. Task 4 runs the whole way through.

Start here Use your approved design from Assignment 1. You can change it if you have a good reason, but write down every change and why. You will need these notes for Task 5.

What you are marked on

To get a Merit you need every Pass and Merit criterion. To get a Distinction you need all of them.

	Criterion	You must show that you can	Task
Pass	2C.P4	Build a spreadsheet from the given dataset, with an input area and an output area. Sort the data, format it, use formulas and functions, and make a chart.	1, 2
	2C.P5	Test that it works, repair faults and record every change.	4
	2D.P6	Explain how the finished spreadsheet suits the user requirements and purpose.	5
Merit	2C.M3	Improve usability and accuracy with on-screen guidance and navigation.	2
	2C.M4	Get feedback from other people, use it to improve the spreadsheet, and test the new features.	4
	2D.M5	Review how well the spreadsheet meets the brief, using that feedback.	5
Distinction	2C.D3	Use automated tools to improve productivity, accuracy and how the output is presented.	3
	2D.D4	Compare the final spreadsheet with your design, justify the changes, and recommend at least three further improvements.	5

01 Build the data model and user interface

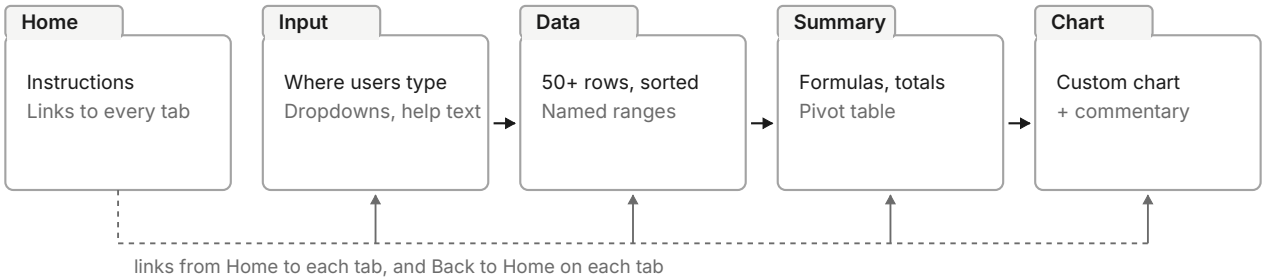
Criteria **2C.P4**

Build a working spreadsheet from the given dataset. It needs an area where users type data in and an area that shows the results.

Your spreadsheet must have

- ☐ At least 50 rows of the given data, with one header row, one record per row and no blank rows.
- ☐ Data sorted in a logical order. Be ready to explain why you chose that order.
- ☐ A clear input area, kept separate from the formulas and the stored data.
- ☐ An output area with formulas and functions that summarise the data.
- ☐ Professional formatting: alignment, borders, a consistent style, £ currency and readable row height.

A possible layout



One way to organise your tabs. Follow your own approved design if it is different.

Hints

- Useful functions: `SUM`, `AVERAGE`, `MIN`, `MAX`, `COUNTIF`, `SUMIF`, `IF`, `VLOOKUP`.
- When you copy a formula that must always point at one cell, lock that cell with $, for example `$B$2`.
- If the currency shows as $ instead of £, set the location: **File › Settings › Locale › United Kingdom**.
- Name versions as you go (see Task 4). Name this one **v1 Basic build** before you move on.

Tool	Where to find it in Google Sheets
Sort	Select the data, then **Data › Sort range › Advanced range sorting options**. Tick **Data has header row**.
Currency	**Format › Number › Currency**
Alignment, wrapping	**Format › Alignment** and **Format › Wrapping**
Borders	Borders button on the toolbar
Banded rows	**Format › Alternating colours**
Row height	Right-click a row number, then **Resize row**
Keep headings visible	**View › Freeze**

02 Guide the user

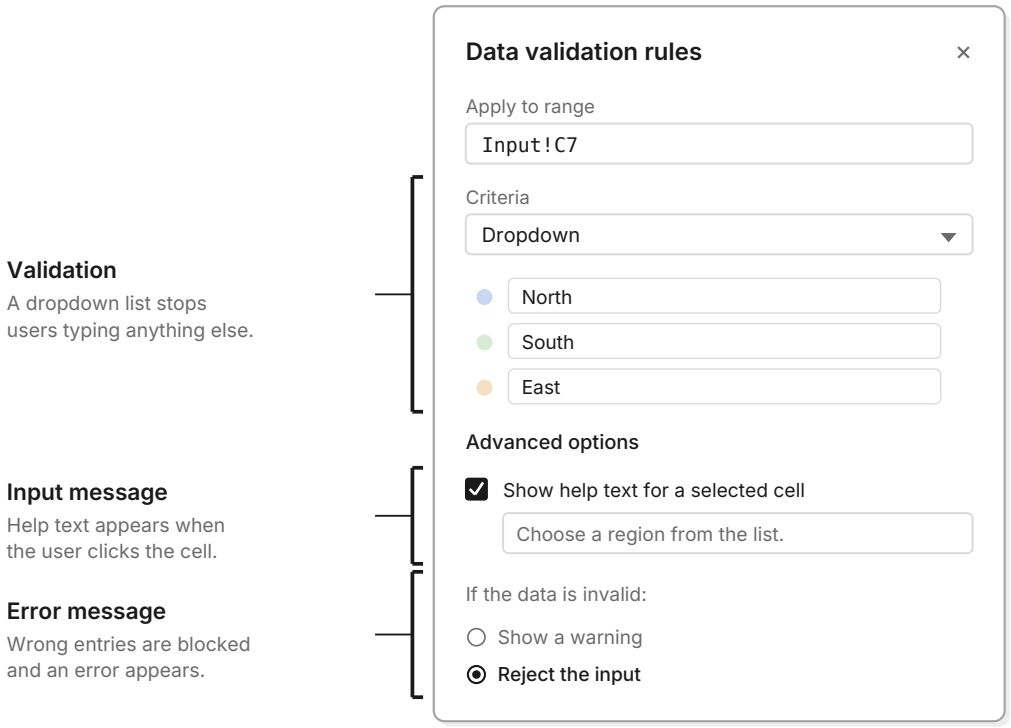
Criteria **2C.M3 (and the chart for 2C.P4)**

Make the spreadsheet easy to use and hard to get wrong. Every feature here should either help the user or stop a mistake.

Your spreadsheet must have

- ☐ Clear labels on every input and every output.
- ☐ At least one dropdown list made with data validation.
- ☐ Input messages (help text) on your input cells.
- ☐ Error messages that reject wrong entries.
- ☐ Navigation: a Home tab with instructions and links to each tab, and a way back to Home.
- ☐ Conditional formatting that highlights important rows automatically.
- ☐ A customised chart of your summary results.
- ☐ A typed commentary, about one page long, that explains the output.

One rule gives you three of the M3 features



The data validation panel. Example values are shown; use your own data.

Hints

- To highlight a whole row, select the whole table, choose **Custom formula is**, and put $ before the column letter, for example `=$E2>1000`. The $ makes every cell in the row check column E.
- Make the chart from your summary, not from all 50 rows. A chart with 50 bars is hard to read.
- Customise the chart: give it a title, axis titles and data labels, and pick a chart type that suits the data.
- For the commentary, explain what the chart shows, why you chose that type of chart, and what the user should notice in it.

– You can also include a data entry form. The Apps Script form from class counts.

Tool	Where to find it in Google Sheets
Data validation	**Data › Data validation › Add rule**
Conditional formatting	**Format › Conditional formatting**
Chart	**Insert › Chart**, then the **Customise** tab in the chart editor
Links between tabs	**Insert › Link** (Ctrl + K), then **Sheets and named ranges**

03 Automate and speed things up

Criteria **2C.D3**

Use automated tools to make the spreadsheet faster, more accurate or better presented. What matters is how much each tool helps the user, not how many tools you use. Record in your test log why you added each one.

Choose from

Tool	What it does for the user	Where to find it
Apps Script	Does a repeated job in one click, for example submitting a form, clearing the inputs, sorting the data or jumping to a tab.	**Extensions › Apps Script**. Add a button with **Insert › Drawing**, then **Assign script**.
Named ranges	Formulas become easier to read and check, for example `=SUM(Sales)`.	**Data › Named ranges**
Pivot table	Summarises many rows by category without writing formulas.	**Insert › Pivot table**
Protection	Stops users breaking formulas while they can still type in the input cells.	**Data › Protect sheets and ranges**. Choose **Sheet**, then **Except certain cells**.
Links	Users move around the spreadsheet and cells pull data from other tabs, for example `=Data!B2`.	**Insert › Link**, or type the reference

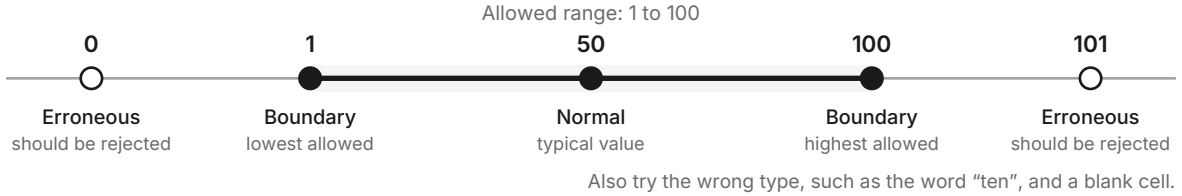
Watch out Test each tool after you add protection. Check your scripts still run, and check users can still type in the input cells. If something breaks, that is a fault to fix and log.

04 Test, get feedback and fix

Criteria **2C.P5** · **2C.M4**

Run your test plan from Assignment 1. Log every test, every fault and every fix, with evidence.

Test with three kinds of data



Also try the wrong type, such as the word “ten”, and a blank cell.

Example for a cell that accepts whole numbers from 1 to 100.

How to collect evidence

- **Versions.** Use **File › Version history › Name current version** at each stage, for example v2 Validation added. Screenshot the version list as evidence.
- **Formula view.** Press **Ctrl +** ` (the key above Tab) to show formulas instead of results, or use **View › Show › Formulas**. Take a screenshot, then press it again to switch back.
- **Screenshots.** On Windows, press **Windows + Shift + S**.
- **Check calculations.** Work out one or two results by hand or with a calculator and compare them with the spreadsheet.
- **When a test fails,** fix it, test it again and log both results. Failed tests that you fix are good evidence.

Test log: suggested columns

No.	What is tested	Test data	Expected	Actual	Pass / Fail	Fix and version	Evidence
1							
2							

Get feedback from other people

Ask classmates or your teacher to use the spreadsheet. Give them real tasks to do, not just "do you like it?"

- Enter a new record. Was anything unclear?
- Find a total or result. How easy was it to find?
- Read the chart. What does it tell you?
- Try to break it by typing something wrong. What happened?

Use the feedback to improve the layout, then test the new features and log the results. For M4, the log needs to show **feedback → change → retest**.

Who	Date	What they tried	What they said	What I changed	Retested?

05 Reflective review

Criteria **2D.P6 · 2D.M5 · 2D.D4**

Use your test results and feedback logs to review the finished spreadsheet. You can write a typed report or record a 2-minute screen video. In a video, show each feature on screen while you talk about it.

Answer these questions

Criterion	Questions to answer
2D.P6	How does each main feature meet a user requirement? Why is the spreadsheet right for its purpose?
2D.M5	How well does it meet the brief? What did users say, what did you change because of it, and what still needs work?
2D.D4	How is the final version different from your Assignment 1 design? Why did you make each change, and was it the right choice?
2D.D4	What are at least three further improvements? For each one, say what it is, how it would help the user, and how you would build it. You do not need to build them.

Write about purpose, not appearance

Weak	Stronger
“I made the headings blue so it looks nice.”	“The dropdown in the Region column means users cannot type a region that does not exist, so the SUMIF totals on the Summary tab stay accurate.”

The stronger version names the feature, the user problem it solves, and the result.

06 Before you hand in

- [ ] The Google Sheet works, has at least 50 rows, and every button and link has been tested.
- [ ] It is shared or submitted the way your teacher asks. A downloaded Excel copy does not keep your Apps Script, so share the Google Sheet itself.
- [ ] The test log covers every test, with expected and actual results, fixes, versions and formula-view screenshots.
- [ ] The feedback log shows who gave feedback, what you changed and that you retested.
- [ ] The chart commentary is included.
- [ ] The review is done, as a typed report or a 2-minute video, and covers all four questions in Task 5.

Avoid Common mistakes: fewer than 50 rows; a chart of raw data instead of a summary; protecting the sheet so that users cannot type in the inputs; a test log with no screenshots; feedback that led to no changes; a review that describes colours instead of purpose.